

UNIVERSITY OF MICHIGAN

CONSENT TO BE PART OF A RESEARCH STUDY

NAME OF STUDY AND RESEARCHERS

Title of Project: Understanding how humans ask and answer clarifying questions

Principal Investigator: Aidan Dempster, PhD student, The University of Michigan

HUM# 00299042

GENERAL INFORMATION

You are invited to participate in a research study intended to examine how humans navigate ambiguous information through multi-turn clarifying dialogs. The purpose of this research is to characterize how people ask and answer clarifying questions when provided with multimodal context, such as text, images, and audio. This information will be used to create a new benchmark dataset to evaluate and train large language models (AI systems), ultimately improving their ability to safely, reliably, and effectively process complex, underspecified real-world requests.

If you agree to be part of the research study, you will be asked to use a secure web platform to review conversation histories from other participants and contribute the next response. You will act as both a "Question Asker," formulating clear follow-up questions and gauging your confidence in the answer, and a "Question Answerer," using hidden information to provide direct and accurate responses to clarifying questions. You will also be asked to provide brief ratings on how relevant, informative, or meaningful previous responses were. Your responses will be collected asynchronously on a computer, allowing you to contribute at your own pace from your home.

Benefits of the research

You will not benefit directly by participating in this study. Information from this study may benefit other people in the future as it will be used to train and evaluate AI systems to increase safety and reliability.

Risks and discomforts

We do not anticipate any substantial risks from participating in this research. Moderation will be employed to prevent you from being shown harmful speech, but if moderation systems fail you may see profanity or insulting statements.

Compensation

You will be compensated with an up to \$30 gift card for your time participating in this study.

If you receive any payments for taking part in this study, the University of Michigan finance department will need your name and address for tax reporting purposes. In a calendar year if: 1) your payments total greater than \$400 for this study or 2) if you receive payments of greater than \$400 for being in more than one study, the University of Michigan finance department will also require your Social Security Number for tax reporting purposes. If you do not wish to provide your Social Security Number, you may continue to participate in research studies, but you will not be able to receive payment for the remainder of the calendar year.

Payment is based on completing the study honestly and meeting all participation requirements. There are situations where you may not receive payment. These include

- You are found to be ineligible based on the screening questions at the start.

- You are found to have provided false information to qualify for the study.
- You submit fewer than 10 responses.
- Your responses are flagged as potentially fraudulent — for example, if they appear random, rushed, or inconsistent with your answers to other questions.

If you believe the decision was made in error, you may contact Aidan Dempster at adempst@umich.edu to discuss the decision.

Taking part is voluntary

Participating in this study is completely voluntary. Even if you decide to participate now, you may change your mind and stop at any time. You may choose not to continue providing responses for any reason. Your relationship with the university will not be affected by the decision to participate in this study.

Privacy & Confidentiality

We will protect the confidentiality of your research records. All identifying information will be securely stored on the cloud; the term “cloud” refers to large computers located in different parts of the world where individuals may keep and remotely access their personal and professional files. Each cloud service has its own policies and methods for preventing unauthorized individuals from accessing files stored on their cloud servers. The cloud service used to store files associated with this study meets University of Michigan protection standards.

Information collected in this project may be shared with other researchers, but we will not share any information that could identify you.

If you have questions about this research study, please contact Aidan Dempster at adempst@umich.edu or Jason Corso at jjcorso@umich.edu.

The University of Michigan Medical School Institutional Review Board (IRBMED) has determined that this study is exempt from IRB oversight.